

# RISHIKESH GALANDE

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## EDUCATION

### Pennsylvania State University

MS in Cybersecurity Analytics & Operations, **GPA: 4.0/4.0.**

**May 2026**

*University Park, PA*

### DY Patil University

B.Tech in Information Technology, **GPA: 3.2/4.0.**

**May 2024**

*Navi Mumbai, India*

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Pennsylvania State University

**Aug 2025 – Present**

*Instructional Assistant*

- Delivered one on one and group technical mentoring for 50+ students to resolve Python programming issues resulting in an estimated 25% improvement in code correctness and assignment completion speed.
- Provided hands on instruction in Splunk and Wireshark to guide students through log analysis and network traffic investigation resulting in approximately 20% higher lab success rates and improved threat detection accuracy across the class.
- Conducted grading and detailed feedback for 100+ coding assignments and cybersecurity labs to identify recurring errors and improvement areas resulting in an estimated 15% increase in overall student performance over the semester.

## PROJECTS

### Privacy-Hardened Raspberry Pi DNS Resolver

- Deployed a network-wide DNS sinkhole using Pi-hole and Unbound, enforcing DNSSEC validation to block malware/phishing and prevent DNS cache poisoning.
- Hardened network privacy by configuring a DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH) fallback with Cloudflared, mitigating DNS hijacking and preventing ISP traffic monitoring.
- Diagnosed and resolved DNS forwarding conflicts through traffic analysis; optimized system performance and memory utilization for low-resource hardware

### Incident Response & Threat Detection Lab

- Engineered a containerized SOC environment using Docker to simulate real-world attack scenarios and validate defensive security controls.
- Deployed Snort as an Intrusion Detection System (IDS) to monitor network traffic and generate alerts on malicious activity, analyzing captured packets with TCPDump.
- Developed Python automation scripts to trigger attack simulations based on the MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling consistent testing of threat detection and response capabilities.

### Blue Team Operations & Threat Hunting (TryHackMe)

- Engineered a containerized SOC environment using Docker to simulate real-world attack scenarios and validate defensive security controls.
- Deployed Snort as an Intrusion Detection System (IDS) to monitor network traffic and generate alerts on malicious activity, analyzing captured packets with TCPDump.
- Developed Python automation scripts to trigger attack simulations based on the MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling consistent testing of threat detection and response capabilities.

## CERTIFICATIONS, SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Certifications:** CompTIA Security Plus, AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, CCNA (Pursuing)
- **Technologies:** Splunk, Wireshark, Nmap, tcpdump, Snort, Suricata, Nessus, Linux, Windows, AWS, Azure, Firewalls, VPNs
- **Skills:** SIEM, Log Analysis, Incident Response, Threat Hunting, DFIR, TCPIP, Network Security, Cloud Security, Vulnerability Management
- **Interests:** Gaming, Soccer, Fitness, Music